Shell or high water

Players: 4

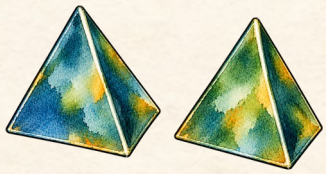
Guide your turtles into the river to gather food for their children, and bring it safely home. The player with the highest total food value at the end wins.

Setup

- Each player stacks their three turtles in the Shore. Each player takes two 1-value food tokens into their hand.
- Setup Rocks tokens and food tokens on the spaces indicated by the board. Setup food tokens **according to color**, with same color tokens being placed randomly. When a food token slot is on the rock, place the rock token at the bottom and the food token at the top.
- The youngest player goes first. Play continues clockwise.

Your Turn

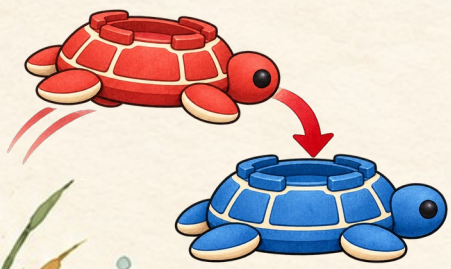
1. Roll two four-sided dice, regardless of how many turtles you have left.
2. Assign each die to a **different** turtle as movement.
3. Move each assigned turtle **up to** the number shown on its die. Moves are orthogonal only. The shore is one single big tile and turtles move **individually off the shore**.



If only one unretired turtle remains, assign either die to it and ignore the other.

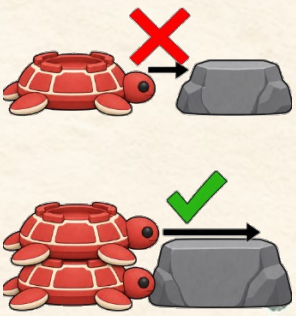
Stacking

- A turtle entering an occupied tile goes on top.
- When a turtle moves, every turtle above it moves with it. Turtles below it stay behind.



Rocks

- A turtle of height one cannot climb or be flooded onto rock tile
- Turtles standing on other turtles can move and be flooded onto rock tile
- A turtle already on a rock may move off it normally.

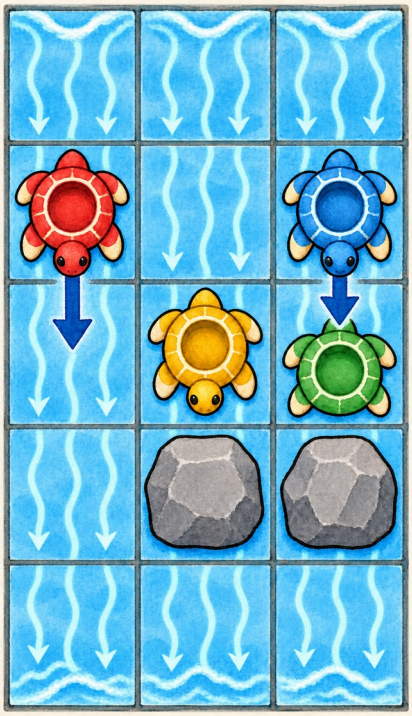


Food



- A turtle can carry **only one** food token. **Food is only obtained in your turn.** At any time in your turn, when a turtle walks over food, it can be picked up. Once picked up, it cannot be dropped.
- A turtle carrying food returning to the Shore adds its food to its player's hand, then retires. Place this turtle at the side of the board.
- If the turtle returns to shore not carrying food, it **does not retire**.

The Tide



After every player has taken a turn, the tide flushes. Move all the turtles in each cell (including rock tiles) **down by 1 tile**, preserving their stack order.

When a stack meets a rock, its bottom turtle stops before the rock; every turtle above it continues.

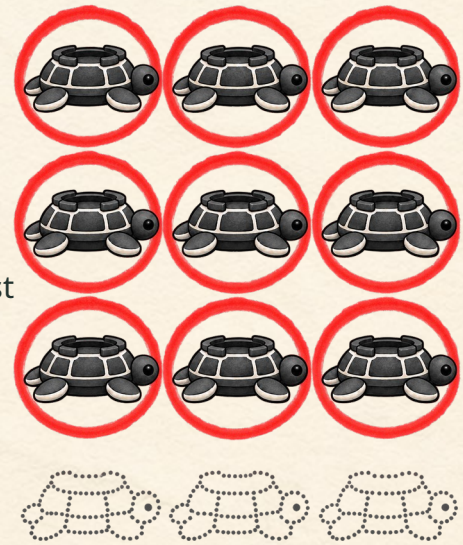
Tide can cause turtles to stack

A turtle pushed beyond the end of the board is washed away with any food it carries. Place this turtle at the side of the board.

Negotiation

Negotiation and trading of food tokens is **allowed**. Binding contracts **may be formed** with the agreement of both players

Game End



The game ends when **9 of the 12** turtles have returned to the Shore or been washed away. If **multiple turtles** enter the shore during the action that puts the 9th turtle on shore, **they are all resolved**.

All players resolve their score.

Add the values of the food tokens in your hand. The highest total wins. If tied, the player furthest from the starting player in the turn order wins.